instruct Spring Cloud Function to use them as building blocks and produce a new function that comes from the composition of those two.

In a serverless application like those meant to be deployed on a FaaS platform (such as AWS Lambda, Azure Functions, Google Cloud Functions, or Knative), you would usually have one function defined per application. The cloud function definition can be mapped one-to-one to a function declared in your application, or you can use the *pipe* (`|`) operator to compose functions together in a data flow. If you need to define multiple functions, you can use the semicolon (`;`) character as the separator instead of the pipe (`|`).

To sum up, you only need to implement standard Java functions, and you can then configure Spring Cloud Function to use them as they are or after combining them. The framework will do the rest, including transparently converting input and output types to make the composition possible. Figure 10.8 illustrates the function composition.

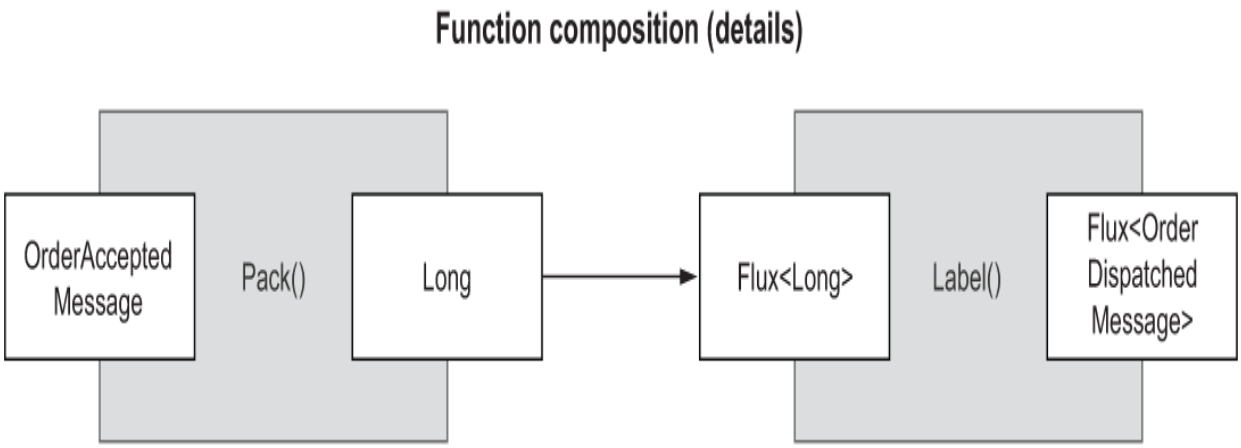


Figure 10.8 You can combine functions with different input and output types and mix imperative and reactive types as well. Spring Cloud Function will transparently handle any type conversion.